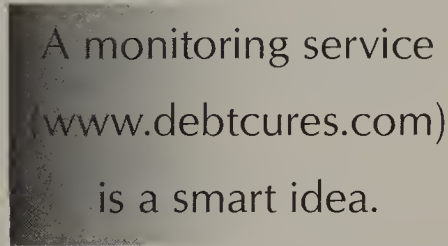


automatically fall off with it. So when you review your credit report from time to time, make sure personal statements get removed, or it could become very confusing.

Somebody Is Watching You

As you can easily see, the credit report has all your secrets. It also includes all your past residences and all your past employers. It is almost like watching an episode of *This Is Your Life*, except there are no surprise reunions or hugs or tears. The credit report is a powerful piece of paper, and it was created by the financial industry for their benefit, not yours. It sort of has that “Big Brother” feel – they know where you work and how long you have worked there, where you live and how long you have lived there. And, of course, they know how much you pay and owe on all your bills.



Your credit information is your track to wealth. Since you cannot stop the train, you have to at least make sure that you are on the right train. You do so by making sure that every bit of information that is reported on the credit report is accurate. The first step to taking control of your credit and your life is to take control of your credit report. It is absolutely critical.

More Than Once a Year

You can, and should, get your credit report more often than once a year. It just won't be free. The Annual Credit Report Request Service is allowed only once a year, just like your birthday. Instead, contact each agency directly. I suggest a credit monitoring service that includes unlimited access to your credit report. You won't have to worry about it again. Peace of mind is worth a few dollars and is a good investment.

You Are in Control

All this information about credit reports may have you feeling a little overwhelmed. Don't be. The point of the information I am giving you